4.6.4 Variable in PHP

PHP has variables like other programing languages such as C, C++ and Python etc. Variables are the storage location, which can store the values for the later manipulations in the program.

The variable in PHP begins with a dollar ($) symbol and the assignment activity implemented using "=" operator, finally the statement ends with semi colon ";" The semicolon indicates the end of statement.

The main advantage of the PHP variable declaration is, it does not requires to specify the data type keyword separately such as int, char, float, double or string etc.

Basic Rules for Variable Declaration

- Variable name must always begin with a $ symbol.
- Variable name can never start with a number.
- Variable names are case-sensitive.

Example:

```
$a=5; $b=10;
$a_1="Computer Application"
$c=$a+$b;
echo $c;
```

4.6.5 PHP Data Type

PHP scripting language supports 13 primitive data types. Data Types play important role in all programing languages to classify the data according to the logics. PHP supports the following data types.

1. String
2. Integer
3. Float
4. Boolean
5. Array
6. Object
7. NULL
8. Resource

String:

String is a collection of characters within the double or single quotes like

"Computer Application" or 'Computer Application'. Space is also considered as a character.

Example:

```
<?php
$x = "Computer Application!";
$y = 'Computer Application';
echo $x;
echo "<br>";
echo $y;
?>
```

Integer:

Integer is a data type which contains non decimal numbers.

Example:

```
<?php
$x = 59135;
var_dump($x);
?>
```

Float:

Float is a data type which contains decimal numbers.

Example:

```
<?php
$x = 19.15;
var_dump($x);
?>
```

Boolean:

Boolean is a data type which denotes the possible two states, TRUE or FALSE

XII CompApp_English version CHAPTER 04.indd 90 23-02-2020 11:23:38